

Develop Android Apps Using MIT App Inventor

There is a secret inventor inside each of us. Get your creative juices flowing and go ahead and develop an Android app or two. It is as easy as you think it is. Follow the detailed instructions given in this article, and you will have an Android app up and running in next to no time.



Imagine that you have come up with an idea for an app to address your own requirements, but due to lack of knowledge and information, don't know where to begin. You could contact an Android developer, who would charge you for his services, and you would also risk having your idea being copied or stolen. You may also feel that you can't develop the app yourself as you do not have the required programming and coding skills. But that's not true. Let me tell you that you can develop Android apps on your own without any programming and coding; and in this article, I am going to let you into the secret of how to go about doing that.

An introduction to App Inventor

App Inventor is a tool that will convert your idea into a working application without the need for any prior coding or programming skills. App Inventor is the open source utility developed by Google in 2010 and, currently, it is being maintained by the Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT). It allows absolute beginners in computer science to develop Android applications. It provides you with a graphical user interface with all the necessary components required to build Android apps. You just need to drag and drop the components in the block editor. Each block is an independent action, which you need to arrange in a logical sequence in order to result in some action.

App Inventor features

App Inventor is a feature-rich open source Android app development tool. Here are its features.

1. **Open source:** Being open source, the tool is free for everyone and you don't need to purchase anything. Open source software also gives you the freedom to customise it as per your own requirements.
2. **Browser based:** App Inventor runs on your browser; hence, you don't need to install anything onto your computer. You just need to log in to your account using your email and password credentials.
3. **Stored on the cloud:** All your app related projects are stored on Google Cloud; therefore, you need not keep anything on your laptop or computer. Being browser based, it allows you to log in to your account from any device and all your work is in sync with the cloud database.
4. **Real-time testing:** App Inventor provides a standalone emulator that enables you to view the behaviour of your apps on a virtual machine. Complete your project and see it running on the emulator in real-time.
5. **No coding required:** As mentioned earlier, it is a tool with a graphical user interface, with all the built-in component blocks and logical blocks. You need to assemble multiple blocks together to result in some behavioural action.
6. **Huge developer community:** You will meet like-minded developers from across the world. You can post your queries regarding certain topics and these will be answered quickly. The community is very supportive and knowledgeable.

System requirements

Given below are the system requirements to run App Inventor from your computer or laptop: